

Comments for Planning Application DM2025/01591

Application Summary

Application Number: DM2025/01591

Address: Ambulance Station Dorset Road Belmont SM2 6JH

Proposal: Change of use from Sui Generis (Ambulance Station) to mixed use Classes F1 (Places of Worship) and F2 (Community Hub) involving the erection of a part one, part two storey front and side extension, increase in height to part of building and provision of cycle and refuse stores.

Case Officer: Polly Davidson

Customer Details

Name: Dr Farheen Mir

Address: 9 Holland Avenue Cheam SM2 6HW

Comment Details

Commenter Type:

Stance: Customer made comments in support of the Planning Application

Comment Reasons:

Comment: I support planning application DM2025/01591 for the change of use of the former ambulance station on Dorset Road. This is a thoughtful proposal that addresses a clear local need.

Preventing health problems is cheaper and more effective than treating them. This proposal delivers exactly that. Community hubs that offer wellbeing activities, social connection, and educational programmes are proven to reduce demand on the NHS. In the same vein, neighbours should welcome this, not object to it. The change from a round-the-clock ambulance station to a community facility with set operating hours represents a significant reduction in the intensity of use at this site.

There is simply nothing like this currently available in the Belmont area. Residents who want to access community or faith facilities have to travel to Sutton town centre or further afield. This proposal would change that.

If the Council wishes to impose specific conditions around hours of use, the applicant has already demonstrated willingness to operate within defined limits. The restricted operating hours provide a sensible framework.

Moreover, it surveyed real conditions at peak time and demonstrated that on-street parking capacity is more than sufficient. The Transport Statement is evidence-based and thorough. I am confident that the proposal will not cause a parking problem.

This is not a token addition; it reflects a real gap in local provision that this facility is designed to fill. The proposal explicitly provides for women's groups, family activities, and provision for elderly residents.

I'd also add that the concern about school-run congestion has been raised by objectors, but the timings simply do not overlap. Friday prayers finish well before the afternoon school pickup begins. The Transport Statement addresses this demonstrably.

For the reasons set out above, I fully support this application and encourage the Council to approve it.